Important MCQs for Ethics Exam Preparation

Q1. Ethics is primarily concerned with:

A. Law enforcement
B. Right and wrong conduct
C. Economic growth
D. Religious rituals
Answer: Right and wrong conduct

Q2. Which branch of ethics studies standards for right conduct?

A. Meta-ethics
B. Normative ethics
C. Descriptive ethics
D. Practical ethics
Answer: Normative ethics

Q3. Which of the following is an intrinsic value?

A. Money
B. Pleasure
C. Medicine
D. A car
Answer: Pleasure

Q4. Consequentialism judges actions based on:

A. Intentions
B. Consequences
C. Duty
D. Tradition
Answer: Consequences

Q5. The principle of utility is best described as:

A. Do your duty
B. Respect everyone
C. Greatest good for the greatest number
D. Act according to law
Answer: Greatest good for the greatest number

Q6. Act utilitarianism requires:

A. Following strict rules
B. Judging each action separately
C. Respecting universal law
D. Ignoring outcomes
Answer: Judging each action separately

Q7. Rule utilitarianism suggests:

A. Always break rules
B. Rules matter if they maximize utility
C. Follow only personal ethics
D. Consequences don't matter
Answer: Rules matter if they maximize utility

Q8. Mill's qualitative hedonism prioritizes:

A. Quantity of pleasure
B. Higher pleasures
C. Lower pleasures
D. Equal pleasures
Answer: Higher pleasures

Q9. Kant's categorical imperative demands:

A. Maximize happiness
B. Act only on universalizable maxims
C. Seek self-interest
D. Respect tradition
Answer: Act only on universalizable maxims

Q10. For Kant, persons must be treated as:

A. Means only
B. Ends in themselves
C. Economic agents
D. Religious beings
Answer: Ends in themselves

Q11. Ross's prima facie duties include:

A. Justice and fidelity
B. Profit and growth
C. Pleasure and pain
D. Obedience and punishment
Answer: Justice and fidelity

Q12. According to Scanlon, an act is wrong if:

A. It breaks the law
B. It is rejected by society
C. It cannot be reasonably accepted by all rational persons
D. It reduces happiness
Answer: It cannot be reasonably accepted by all rational persons

Q13. Virtue ethics primarily evaluates:

A. Consequences
B. Character
C. Rules
D. Wealth
Answer: Character

Q14. Eudaimonia refers to:

A. Wealth
B. Flourishing
C. Power
D. Pleasure only
Answer: Flourishing

Q15. Aristotle defined virtue as:

A. A divine command
B. A state involving choice lying in a mean
C. A habit of vice
D. A legal duty

Answer: A state involving choice lying in a mean

Q16. Socrates believed virtue is:

A. Unnecessary
B. Sufficient for happiness
C. Opposed to knowledge
D. Dependent on wealth
Answer: Sufficient for happiness

Q17. Professional ethics are often codified in:

A. Personal morals
B. Codes of conduct
C. Religious texts
D. Customs
Answer: Codes of conduct

Q18. Integrity in professional ethics refers to:

A. Economic success
B. Consistency of actions and values
C. Secrecy
D. Flexibility
Answer: Consistency of actions and values

Q19. Transparency means:

A. Keeping information hidden
B. Openness and accountability
C. Profit maximization
D. Strict obedience
Answer: Openness and accountability

Q20. Accountability in ethics refers to:

A. Avoiding responsibility
B. Answerability and responsibility
C. Only profits matter
D. Personal secrecy
Answer: Answerability and responsibility

Q21. Confidentiality means:

A. Sharing all data
B. Respecting privacy of information
C. Ignoring secrecy
D. Transparency only
Answer: Respecting privacy of information

Q22. Social ethics emphasizes:

A. Individual gain
B. Justice and fairness
C. Profit
D. Power
Answer: Justice and fairness

Q23. Universality in ethics means:

A. Values differ for each
B. Same principles apply to all
C. Only culture defines ethics
D. No rules exist
Answer: Same principles apply to all

Q24. Solidarity means:

A. Competition
B. Mutual support and cooperation
C. Self-interest
D. Economic growth
Answer: Mutual support and cooperation

Q25. Empathy is defined as:

A. Ignoring others' feelings
B. Understanding others' feelings
C. Legal duty
D. Self-interest
Answer: Understanding others' feelings

Q26. The rights perspective in ethics focuses on:

A. Duties
B. Dignity and autonomy
C. Profit
D. Tradition
Answer: Dignity and autonomy

Q27. Justice perspective emphasizes:

A. Equal and fair treatment
B. Profit sharing
C. Wealth accumulation
D. Tradition
Answer: Equal and fair treatment

Q28. The utilitarian perspective emphasizes:

A. Maximizing happiness
B. Strict law-following
C. Religious devotion
D. Self-interest
Answer: Maximizing happiness

Q29. The common good approach emphasizes:

A. Flourishing of all members of society
B. Only personal good
C. Economic growth only
D. Power concentration
Answer: Flourishing of all members of society

Q30. Care ethics emphasizes:

A. Rules only
B. Relationships and specific context
C. Strict law
D. Profit motives

Answer: Relationships and specific context

Q31. Morally obligatory actions are:

A. Optional
B. Required
C. Forbidden
D. Neutral
Answer: Required

Q32. Supererogatory actions are:

A. Forbidden
B. Admirable but not required
C. Always required
D. Always wrong
Answer: Admirable but not required

Q33. Forbidden actions are:

A. Always permissible
B. Morally required not to do
C. Optional
D. Supererogatory
Answer: Morally required not to do

Q34. Permissible actions are:

A. Always forbidden
B. Not forbidden
C. Always required
D. Always harmful
Answer: Not forbidden

Q35. Meta-ethics deals with:

A. Nature of moral judgments
B. Economic theory
C. Religion
D. Law only
Answer: Nature of moral judgments

Q36. Which is an example of deontological ethics?

A. Kantian Ethics
B. Utilitarianism
C. Hedonism
D. Ethical Egoism
Answer: Kantian Ethics

Q37. Which philosopher argued 'better to be a human dissatisfied than a pig satisfied'?

A. Kant
B. Bentham
C. Mill
D. Ross
Answer: Mill

Q38. Which philosopher is associated with contractualism?

A. Kant
B. Ross
C. Scanlon
D. Aristotle
Answer: Scanlon

Q39. Which philosopher introduced the concept of higher and lower pleasures?

A. Mill
B. Kant
C. Aristotle
D. Ross
Answer: Mill

Q40. Which philosopher emphasized the harmony between morality and self-interest?

A. Plato and Aristotle
B. Kant
C. Scanlon
D. Hobbes
Answer: Plato and Aristotle

Q41. Who introduced the concept of prima facie duties?

A. Ross
B. Kant
C. Mill
D. Hume
Answer: Ross

Q42. Which theory holds that moral claims arise from God's command?

A. Divine command theory
B. Utilitarianism
C. Virtue ethics
D. Contractualism
Answer: Divine command theory

Q43. Which ethical lens focuses on character traits?

A. Virtue ethics
B. Utilitarianism
C. Justice
D. Rights
Answer: Virtue ethics

Q44. Which ethical lens is rooted in relationships?

A. Care ethics
B. Utilitarianism
C. Rights
D. Justice
Answer: Care ethics

Q45. The principle of universality is central to which philosopher?

A. Bentham
B. Kant
C. Mill
D. Ross

Answer: Kant

Q46. Which philosopher defined happiness as 'flourishing'?

A. Socrates
B. Plato
C. Aristotle
D. Hobbes
Answer: Aristotle

Q47. According to Aristotle, virtues lie:

A. In extremes
B. In a mean
C. In laws
D. In religion
Answer: In a mean

Q48. Which philosopher argued knowledge is sufficient for virtue?

A. Socrates
B. Kant
C. Ross
D. Mill
Answer: Socrates

Q49. Which ethical theory asks 'What sort of person should I be?'

A. Utilitarianism
B. Virtue ethics
C. Deontology
D. Egoism
Answer: Virtue ethics

Q50. Which ethical perspective emphasizes fairness in distribution of burdens?

A. Justice
B. Care
C. Utilitarian
D. Rights
Answer: Justice